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PACKAGE LEAFLET: INFORMATION FOR THE USER

Sertraline 50 mg Film-coated Tablets

Sertraline 100 mg Film-coated Tablets

Sertraline

Read all of this leaflet carefully before you start taking this medicine because it contains important information for you.

- Keep this leaflet. You may need to read it again.
- If you have any further questions, ask your doctor or pharmacist.
- This medicine has been prescribed for you only. Do not pass it on to others. It may harm them, even if their signs of illness are the same as yours.
- If you get any side effects, talk to your doctor or pharmacist. This includes any possible side effects not listed in this leaflet. See section 4.

What is this leaflet:

1. What Sertraline Film-coated Tablet is and what it is used for
2. What you need to know before you take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets
3. How to take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets
4. Possible side effects
5. How to store Sertraline Film-coated Tablets
6. Contents of the pack and other information

1. WHAT SERTRALINE FILM-COATED TABLET IS AND WHAT IT IS USED FOR

Sertraline Film-coated Tablets contains the active substance sertraline.

Sertraline is one of a group of medicines called Selective Serotonin Re-uptake Inhibitors (SSRIs); these medicines are used to treat depression and/or anxiety disorders.

Sertraline Film-coated Tablets can be used to treat:

- Depression and prevention of recurrence of depression (in adults).
- Social anxiety disorder (in adults).
- Post traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) (in adults).
- Panic disorder (in adults).
- Obsessive compulsive disorder (OCD) (in adults and children and adolescents aged 6-17 years old).

Depression is a clinical illness with symptoms like feeling sad, unable to sleep properly or to enjoy life a you used to.

OCD and Panic disorders are illnesses linked to anxiety with symptoms like being constantly troubled by persistent ideas (obsessions) that make you carry out repetitive rituals (compulsions).

PTSD is a condition that can occur after a very emotionally traumatic experience, and has some symptoms that are similar to depression and anxiety. Social anxiety disorder (social phobia) is an illness linked to anxiety. It is characterised by feelings of intense anxiety or distress in social situations (for example: talking to strangers, speaking in front of groups of people, eating or drinking in front of others or worrying that you might behave in an embarrassing manner).

Your doctor has decided that this medicine is suitable for treating your illness.

You should ask your doctor if you are unsure why you have been given Sertraline Film-coated Tablets.

2. WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW BEFORE YOU TAKE SERTRALINE FILM-COATED TABLETS

Do not take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets:

- If you are allergic to sertraline or any of the other ingredients of this medicine (listed in section 6).
- If you are taking or have taken medicines called monoamine oxidase inhibitors (MAOIs) such as selegiline, moclobemide) or MAOI like drugs (such as linezolid). If you stop treatment with sertraline, you must wait until at least one week before you start treatment with a MAOI. After stopping treatment with a MAOI, you must wait at least 2 weeks before you can start treatment with sertraline.
- If you are taking another medicine called pimozide (a medicine for mental disorders such as psychosis).

Warnings and precautions

Talk to your doctor or pharmacist before taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets.

Medicines are not always suitable for everyone. Tell your doctor before you take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets, if you suffer from or have suffered in the past from any of the following conditions:

- If you have epilepsy (fit) or a history of seizures. If you have a fit (seizure), contact your doctor immediately.
- If you have suffered from manic depressive illness (bipolar disorder) or schizophrenia. If you have a manic episode, contact your doctor immediately.
- If you have or have previously had thoughts of harming or killing yourself (see below- Thoughts of suicide and worsening of your depression or anxiety disorder).
- If you have Serotonin Syndrome. In rare cases this syndrome may occur when you are taking certain medicines at the same time as sertraline. (For symptoms, see section 4. Possible Side Effects). Your doctor will have told you whether you have suffered from this in the past.
- If you have low sodium level in your blood, since this can occur as a result of treatment with Sertraline Film-coated Tablets. You should also tell your doctor if you are taking certain medicines for hypertension, since these medicines may also alter the sodium level in your blood.
- If you are elderly as you may be more at risk of having low sodium level in your blood (see above).
- If you have liver disease; your doctor may decide that you should have a lower dose of Sertraline Film-coated Tablets.
- If you have diabetes; your blood glucose levels may be altered due to Sertraline Film-coated Tablets and your diabetes medicines may need to be adjusted.
- If you have suffered from bleeding disorders or have been taking medicines which thin the blood (e.g. acetylsalicylic acid (aspirin), or warfarin) or may increase the risk of bleeding or if you are pregnant (see Pregnancy, breast-feeding and fertility).
- If you are a child or adolescent under 18 years old. Sertraline Film-coated Tablets should only be used to treat children and adolescents aged 6-17 years old, suffering from obsessive compulsive disorder (OCD). If you are being treated for this disorder, your doctor will want to monitor you closely (see below-Children and adolescents).
- If you are having electro-convulsive therapy (ECT).
- If you have eye problems, such as certain kinds of glaucoma (increased pressure in the eye).
- If you have been told that you have an abnormality of your heart tracing after an electrocardiogram (ECG) known as prolonged QT interval.
- If you have heart disease, low potassium levels or low magnesium levels, family history of QT prolongation, low heart rate and concomitant use of medications which prolong QT interval.
- The use of Buprenorphine together with Sertraline can lead to Serotonin syndrome, a potentially life-threatening condition (see "Other medicines and Sertraline").

Restlessness/Akathisia:

The use of sertraline has been linked to a distressing restlessness and need to move, often being unable to sit or stand still (akathisia). This is most likely to occur during the first few weeks of treatment.

Increasing the dose may be harmful so if you develop such symptoms you should talk to your doctor.

Withdrawal reactions:

Side effects relating to stopping treatment (withdrawal reactions) are common, particularly if the treatment is stopped suddenly (see section 3 if you stop taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets and section 4 Possible side effects). The risk of withdrawal symptoms depends on the length of treatment, dosage, and the rate at which the dose is reduced. Generally, such symptoms are mild to moderate. However, they can be serious in some patients. They normally occur within the first few days after stopping treatment. In general, such symptoms disappear on their own and wear off within 2 weeks. In some patients they may last longer (2-3 months or more). When stopping treatment with sertraline it is recommended to reduce the dose gradually over a period of several weeks or months, and you should always discuss the best way of stopping treatment with your doctor.

Thoughts of suicide and worsening of your depression or anxiety disorder:

If you are depressed and/or have anxiety disorders you can sometimes have thoughts of harming or killing yourself. These may be increased when first starting antidepressants, since these medicines all take time to work, usually about two weeks but sometimes longer.

You may be more likely to think like this:

- If you have previously had thoughts about killing or harming yourself.
- If you are a young adult. Information from clinical trials has shown an increased risk of suicidal behaviour in adults aged less than 25 years with psychiatric conditions who were treated with an antidepressant.

If you have thoughts of harming or killing yourself at any time, contact your doctor or go to a hospital straight away.

You may find it helpful to tell a relative or close friend that you are depressed or have an anxiety disorder, and ask them to read this leaflet. You might ask them to tell you if they think your depression or anxiety is getting worse, or if they are worried about changes in your behaviour.

Sexual problems:

Medicines like Sertraline (so called SSRIs) may cause symptoms of sexual dysfunction (see section 4). In some cases, these symptoms have continued after stopping treatment.

Children and adolescents

Sertraline should not usually be used in children and adolescents less than 18 years old, except for patients with Obsessive Compulsive Disorder (OCD). Patients under 18 have an increased risk of undesirable effects, such as suicide attempt, thoughts of harming or killing themselves (suicidal thoughts) and hostility (mainly aggressiveness, oppositional behaviour and anger) when they are treated with this class of medicines. Nevertheless, it is possible that your doctor decides to prescribe Sertraline Film-coated Tablets to a patient under 18 if it is in the patient's interest. If your doctor has prescribed Sertraline Film-coated Tablets to you and you are less than 18 years old and you want to discuss this, please contact him/her. Furthermore, if any of the symptoms listed above appear or worsen while you are taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets, you should inform your doctor. Also, the long-term safety of Sertraline Film-coated Tablets in regard to growth, maturation and learning (cognitive) and behavioural development in this age group has not yet been demonstrated.

Other medicines and Sertraline Film-coated Tablets

Tell your doctor or pharmacist if you are taking, have recently taken or might take any other medicines.

Some medicines can affect the way Sertraline Film-coated Tablets works, or Sertraline Film-coated Tablets itself can reduce the effectiveness of other medicines taken at the same time.

Taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets together with the following medicines may cause serious side effects:

- Medicines called monoamine oxidase inhibitors (MAOIs), like moclobemide (to treat depression) and selegiline (to treat Parkinson's disease), the antibiotic linezolid and methylene blue (to treat high levels of methaemoglobin in the blood). Do not use Sertraline Film-coated Tablets together with these medicines.
- Medicines to treat mental disorders such as psychosis (pimozide). Do not use Sertraline Film-coated Tablets together with pimozide.
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3. HOW TO TAKE SERTRALINE FILM-COATED TABLETS Always take this medicine exactly as your doctor or pharmacist has told you. Check with your doctor or pharmacist if you are not sure. The recommended dose is: Adults: Depression and obsessive Compulsive Disorder For depression and OCD, the usual effective dose is 50 mg/day. The daily dose may be increased in 50 mg increments and at intervals of at least one week over a period of weeks. The maximum recommended dose is 200 mg/day. Panic disorder, Social anxiety disorder and Post Traumatic Stress Disorder: For panic disorder, social anxiety disorder and post traumatic stress disorder, treatment should be started at 25 mg/day, and increased to 50 mg/day after one week. The daily dose then may be increased in 50 mg increments over a period of weeks. The maximum recommended dose is 200 mg/day. Use in children and adolescents: Sertraline Film-coated Tablets must only be used to treat children and adolescents suffering from OCD aged 6-17 years old. Obsessive Compulsive Disorder: Children aged 6 to 12: the recommended starting dose is 25 mg daily After one week, your doctor may increase this to 50 mg daily The maximum dose is 200 mg daily Adolescents aged 13 to 17: the recommended starting dose is 50 mg daily The maximum dose is 200 mg daily. If you have liver or kidney problems, please tell your doctor and follow the doctor's instructions. <u>Method of administration:</u> Sertraline Film-coated Tablets tablets may be taken with or without food. Take your medication once daily either in the morning or evening. The tablet can be divided into equal halves. Your doctor will advise you on how long to take this medication for. This will depend on the nature of your illness and how well you are responding to the treatment. It may take several weeks before your symptoms begin to improve. Treatment of depression should usually continue for 6 months after improvement. If you take more Sertraline Film-coated Tablets than you should If you accidentally take too much Sertraline Film-coated Tablets contact your doctor at once or go to the nearest hospital casualty department. Always take the labelled medicine package with you, whether there is any medication left or not. Symptoms of overdose may include drowsiness, nausea and vomiting, rapid heart rate, shaking, agitation, dizziness and in rare cases unconsciousness. If you forget to take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets Do not take a double dose to make up for a forgotten dose. If you forget to take a dose, do not take the missed dose. Just take the next dose at the right time. If you stop taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets Do not stop taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets unless your doctor tells you to. Your doctor will want to gradually reduce your dose of Sertraline Film-coated Tablets over several weeks, before you finally stop taking this medicine. If you suddenly stop taking this medicine you may experience side effects such as dizziness, numbness, sleep disturbances, agitation or anxiety, headaches, feeling sick, being sick and shaking. If you experience any of these side effects, or any other side effects whilst stopping taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets, please speak to your doctor. If you have any further questions on the use of this product, ask your doctor or pharmacist.		PHAMA CODE
4. POSSIBLE SIDE EFFECTS Like all medicines, this medicine can cause side effects, although not everybody gets them. Nausea is the most common side effect. The side effects depend on the dose and often disappear or lessen with continued treatment. Tell your doctor immediately: • If you experience any of the following symptoms after taking this medicine, these symptoms can be serious. • If you develop a severe skin rash that causes blistering (erythema multiforme), (this can affect the mouth and throat). These may be signs of a condition known as Stevens Johnson Syndrome, or Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis (TEN). Your doctor will stop your treatment in these cases. • Allergic reaction allergy, which may include symptoms such as an itchy skin rash, breathing problems, wheezing, swollen eyelids, face or lips. • If you experience agitation, confusion, diarrhoea, high temperature and blood pressure, excessive sweating and rapid heartbeat. These are symptoms of Serotonin Syndrome. In rare cases this syndrome may occur when you are taking certain medicines at the same time as sertraline. Your doctor may wish to stop your treatment. • If you develop yellow skin and eyes which may mean liver damage. • If you experience depressive symptoms with ideas of harming or killing yourself (suicidal thoughts). • If you start to get feelings of restlessness and are not able to sit or stand still after you start to take Sertraline Film-coated Tablets. You should tell your doctor if you start to feel restless. • If you have a fit (seizure). • If you have a manic episode (see section 2 “Warnings and precautions”). The following side effects were seen in clinical trials in adults and after marketing. Very common (may affect more than 1 in 10 people): Insomnia, dizziness, sleepiness, headache, diarrhoea, feeling sick, dry mouth, ejaculation failure, fatigue. Common (may affect up to 1 in 10 people): • chest cold, sore throat, runny nose, • decreased appetite, increased appetite, • anxiety, depression, agitation, decreased sexual interest, nervousness, feeling strange, nightmare, teeth grinding. • shaking, muscular movement problems (such as moving a lot, tense muscles, difficulty walking and stiffness, spasms and involuntary movements of muscles)*, numbness and tingling, muscle tense, lack of attention, abnormal taste, • visual disturbance, • ringing in ears, • palpitations, • hot flush, • yawning, • upset stomach, constipation, abdominal pain, vomiting, gas, • increased sweating, rash, • back pain, joint pain, muscle pain, • menstrual irregularities, erectile dysfunction, • malaise, chest pain, weakness, fever, • weight increased, • injury. Uncommon (may affect up to 1 in 100 people): • gastroenteritis, ear infection, • tumour, • hypersensitivity, seasonal allergy, • low thyroid hormones, • suicidal thoughts, suicidal behaviour*, psychotic disorder, thinking abnormal, lack of caring, hallucination, aggression, euphoric mood, paranoia, • amnesia, decreased feeling, involuntary muscle contractions, passing out, moving a lot, migraine, convulsion, dizziness while standing up, abnormal coordination, speech disorder, enlarged pupils, • ear pain, • fast heartbeat, heart problem • bleeding problems (such as stomach bleeding)*, high blood pressure, flushing, blood in urine, • shortness of breath, nose bleed, breathing difficulty, possible wheezing, • tarry stools, tooth disorder, inflammation of the oesophagus, tongue problem, haemorrhoids, increased saliva, difficulty swallowing, burning, tongue disorder, • eye swelling, hives, hair loss, itching, purple spots on skin, skin problem with blisters, dry skin, face oedema, cold sweat, • osteoarthritis, muscle twitching, muscle cramps*, muscular weakness,		• increase in frequency of urination, problem urinating unable to urinate, urinary incontinence, increase in urination, nighttime urination, • sexual dysfunction, excessive vaginal bleeding, vaginal haemorrhage, female sexual dysfunction, • swelling in legs, chills, difficulty walking, thirst, • increase in liver enzyme levels, weight decreased. • Cases of suicidal ideation and suicidal behaviours have been reported during sertraline therapy or early after treatment discontinuation (see section 2). Rare (may affect up to 1 in 1,000 people): • diverticulitis, swollen lymph glands, decrease in clotting cells*, decrease in white blood cells*, severe allergic reaction, • endocrine problems*, • high cholesterol, problems controlling blood sugar levels (diabetes), low blood sugar, increase in blood sugar levels*, low blood salt*, • physical symptoms due to stress or emotions, terrifying abnormal dreams*, drug dependence, sleep walking, premature ejaculation, • coma, abnormal movements, difficulty moving, increased sensation, sudden severe headache (which may be a sign of a serious condition known as Reversible Cerebral Vasoconstriction Syndrome (RCVS))*, • sensory disturbance, • spots in front of eyes, glaucoma, double vision, light hurts eye, blood in the eye, unequal sized pupils*, vision abnormal*, tear problem, • heart attack, light-headedness, fainting, or chest discomfort which could be signs of changes in the electrical activity (seen on electrocardiogram) or abnormal rhythm of the heart*, slow heartbeat, • poor circulation of arms and legs, • breathing fast, progressive scarring of lung tissue (Interstitial Lung Disease)*, closing up of throat, difficulty talking, breathing slow, hiccups, • mouth ulceration, pancreatitis*, blood in stool, tongue ulceration, sore mouth, • problems with liver function, serious liver function problems*, yellow skin and eyes (jaundice)*, skin reaction to sun*, skin oedema*, hair texture abnormal, skin odour abnormal, hair rash, • breakdown of muscle tissue*, bone disorder, • urinary hesitation, decreased urination, • breast discharge, dry vaginal area, genital discharge, red painful penis and foreskin, breast enlargement*, prolonged erection, • hernia, drug tolerance decreased, • increase in blood cholesterol levels, abnormal laboratory tests*, semen abnormal, problems with clotting*, • relaxation of blood vessels procedure. Not known: frequency cannot be estimated from the available data: • lockjaw*, • bedwetting*, • partial loss of vision • Heavy vaginal bleeding shortly after birth (postpartum haemorrhage), • see Pregnancy, breast-feeding and fertility in section 2 for more information. • Inflammation of the colon (causing diarrhoea). • Muscle weakness and severe muscle pain, which can be a sign of multiple acyl-coenzyme A dehydrogenase deficiency (MADD)-like disorder. * Side effect reported after marketing Additional side effects in children and adolescents In clinical trials with children and adolescents, the side effects were generally similar to adults (see above). The most common side effects in children and adolescents were headache, insomnia, diarrhoea and feeling sick. Symptoms that can occur when treatment is discontinued If you suddenly stop taking this medicine you may experience side effects such as dizziness, numbness, sleep disturbances, agitation or anxiety, headaches, feeling sick, being sick and shaking (see section 3. “If you stop taking Sertraline Film-coated Tablets”). An increased risk of bone fractures has been observed in patients taking this type of medicines. Reporting of side effects If you get any side effects, talk to your doctor, pharmacist or nurse. This includes any possible side effects not listed in this leaflet. You can also report side effects directly via the Yellow Card Scheme at: www.mhra.gov.uk/yellowcard or search for MHRA Yellow Card in the Google Play or Apple App Store. By reporting side effects you can help provide more information on the safety of this medicine. 5. HOW TO STORE SERTRALINE FILM-COATED TABLETS Keep this medicine out of the sight and reach of children. Do not use this medicine after the expiry date which is stated on the pack after EXP. The expiry date refers to the last day of that month. Tablets which are supplied in bottles should be used within 100 days of first opening. Store below 25°C. Store in the original pack in order to protect from moisture. Do not throw away any medicines via wastewater or household waste. Ask your pharmacist how to throw away medicines you no longer use. These measures will help protect the environment. 6. CONTENTS OF THE PACK AND OTHER INFORMATION What Sertraline Film-coated Tablets contains: • Each film-coated tablet contains 50 mg of sertraline (as sertraline hydrochloride). • Each film-coated tablet contains 100 mg of sertraline (as sertraline hydrochloride). The other ingredients are: Sertraline 50 mg Film-coated Tablets: microcrystalline cellulose, sodium starch glycolate (Type A), hydroxypropyl cellulose, polysorbate 80, calcium hydrogen phosphate dihydrate, colloidal anhydrous silica, magnesium stearate, hypromellose, titanium dioxide (E171), propylene glycol, talc and iron oxide yellow (E172). Sertraline 100 mg Film-coated Tablets: microcrystalline cellulose, sodium starch glycolate (Type A), hydroxypropyl cellulose, polysorbate 80, calcium hydrogen phosphate dihydrate, colloidal anhydrous silica, magnesium stearate, hypromellose, titanium dioxide (E171), propylene glycol and talc. What Sertraline Film-coated Tablets look like and contents of the pack Sertraline 50 mg film-coated tablets are yellow, capsule shaped film-coated tablets with break line on one side and plain on other side. Sertraline 100 mg film-coated tablets are white to off white, capsule shaped, film-coated tablets with break line on one side and plain on other side. Sertraline Film-coated Tablets are available in aluminium-PVC/PVDC blister pack of 10, 14, 20, 28, 30, 50, 56, 60, 84, 98 or 100 tablets. Sertraline Film-coated Tablets are available in white opaque HDPE bottle with white polypropylene cap containing 100 or 500 tablets. Not all pack sizes may be marketed. Marketing Authorisation Holder Flamingo Pharma (UK) Ltd. 1st Floor, Kirkland House, 11-15 Peterborough Road, Harrow, Middlesex, HA1 2AX, United Kingdom. Manufacturer Flamingo Pharma (UK) Limited The Bloc, 38 Springfield Way, Anlaby, Hull, HU10 6RJ, United Kingdom This leaflet has last revised in 06/2025. PL 43461/0060 PL 43461/0061 POM MPLLXERXXXBTBOMFPLXXX114V04